

Martina Repetto

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Education

- 2023-present **PhD in Economics** - University of Melbourne
Committee: Kevin Staub, Susan J. Méndez, Anthony Scott (Monash)
- 2021-2022 **Master of Commerce (Economics)** - University of Melbourne
- 2017-2019 **Master of Economics** - Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore, Milan
Final dissertation: Personality Traits and Labour Market Participation
Grade: 110/110
- 2014-2017 **Bachelor of Economics and Management** - Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore, Milan
Grade: 110 cum laude

Research Fields and Skills

Fields Health Economics | Labour Economics | Behavioural Economics | Gender Economics

Data Analysis Large Administrative Datasets | Data Linkage | Text-Based Analysis | Web-Scraping | Survey Data

Software Stata | Python | R | LaTeX

Languages English | Italian (Native)

Job Market Paper

“When Female Doctors Fly In: Access to Female Physicians in Primary Care”

Abstract: Combining rich administrative health records with a new dataset on a medical outreach program, I study how access to female physicians shapes women’s primary care. The program sends a visiting female doctor to rural Australian towns where all resident doctors are male, allowing me to examine two complementary margins: a choice margin, comparing the same woman’s encounters with the female GP to her encounters with local male providers, and an access margin, exploiting program entry across towns. I find striking differences in the content of care: among encounters involving a prescription, the same woman is roughly four times as likely to receive hormonal or genitourinary medication when seeing the female GP, while among days with a billed medical service, cervical cancer screening is more than ten times as likely when she consults the female GP. Complementary difference-in-differences estimates show that prescribing changes following program entry are concentrated among women who eventually use the service. The pattern is consistent with both women being more comfortable discussing hormonal and gynaecological concerns with the female GP, and with the female GP adopting a different practice style. The findings suggest that policies addressing physician shortages may need to consider not only the aggregate supply of doctors, but also the composition of the local workforce.

Publications

- **“Pandemic Shocks and Unintended Healthcare Disruptions: Chronic Patients During COVID-19”**, (with Claudio Lucifora & Antonio Russo), *Empirical Economics*, 2026
- **“Gender Mix Prescription: Is it the Cure for Job Satisfaction and Retention?”**, (with Margherita Agnoletto), *Labour Economics*, 2025
- **“Big Five Personality Traits and Retirement Decisions”**, (with Claudio Lucifora), *Labour*, 2021

Working Papers

“From Awareness to Action: Help-Seeking and Femicides after Gender-Based Violence Campaigns in Italy”
(with Margherita Agnoletto)

Awareness campaigns are among the most widely deployed policy responses to gender-based violence, yet systematic evidence on their behavioural effects remains scarce. This paper examines whether variation in campaign intensity around the International Day for the Elimination of Violence against Women (November 25) affects help-seeking behaviour and femicide rates in Italy. We exploit the unusually high salience of the 2023 campaign in a difference-in-differences design that compares outcomes before and after November 25 across years of varying intensity. Helpline calls to the national 1522 anti-violence line increase by approximately 160% in the weeks following the high-intensity campaign, with the effect concentrated among non-victim callers. Femicides decline by approximately 61% during high-intensity campaign months. Event-study specifications reveal no differential pre-trends, and placebo tests yield null effects for alternative treatment years, supporting a causal interpretation of the estimates. These findings suggest that awareness campaigns can be effective tools for gender-based violence prevention.

“When Dads Can’t Get on the Beers: The Positive Impact of COVID-19 on Parental Drinking Behaviour” (with Susan J. Méndez, Susan Sawyer & Julie Moschion)

We estimate the effect of COVID-19 restrictions on alcohol consumption among parents living in Victoria. We combine detailed drinking information from the Victorian Adolescent Health Cohort Study, quasi-random variation in survey timing around Victoria’s first lockdown in March 2020, and a difference-in-differences design. We find that heavy drinking among fathers falls substantially: high-risk drinking declines by 26%, binge drinking drops by 28%, and peak single-occasion consumption decreases by approximately four standard drinks. Effects are entirely absent among mothers, concentrated among fathers of younger children, and grow larger under the second, longer lockdown. Descriptive evidence points to weekend drinking as the primary margin of adjustment, consistent with the removal of social occasions rather than financial hardship as the operative mechanism. These findings suggest that the structure of social opportunities shapes household drinking behaviour, and that policies intended to re-shape daily routines can generate substantial reductions in alcohol consumption even when not explicitly designed for this target.

Work in Progress

“Screening take-up in young women: Evidence from a cervical cancer screening program in Italy”

Media Publications

- **“Could we be entering a new era in women’s health funding?”**, *Pursuit*, March 7, 2025.

Chapters in reports and books (Italian)

- **“Chapter 1.1, 1.2, 1.5 in I territori e gli obiettivi di sviluppo sostenibile 2021”**, *Rapporto ASviS*, 2021
- **“Contributions in I territori e gli obiettivi di sviluppo sostenibile”**, *Rapporto ASviS*, 2020
- **“SDG4 and SDG8 in Rapporto Lombardia 2020”**, ISBN 978-88-6250-809-4, 113-129, 183-201, 2020
- **“Contributions in Alla ricerca del benessere: desideri, timori, rappresentazioni della Milano che sarà**, *Presentazione della ricerca Policy Delphi del laboratorio sul futuro milano2046*, Comune di Milano, 2020

Visits

2026 **University of Manchester** - Visiting Researcher (Aug-Oct 2026), Sponsor: Matt Sutton

2016 **Toulouse Business School** - Erasmus Student (First Semester)

Short-Term Department Visits

2026* Università della Svizzera Italiana (USI) | Paris Nanterre University | Centre for Health Economics (York) IE Business School | University of Lucerne | University of Lausanne | University of Barcelona

2024 Monash Centre for Health Economics

2023 Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore

Conference & Seminar Presentations

- 2026
- Discussant, European Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics (EWEHE), Vienna
 - European Health Economics Association (EuHEA) PhD Conference, Nuremberg
 - Health Organisation, Policy and Economics (HOPE) Seminar, University of Manchester
 - Seminar, Paris Nanterre University*
 - Seminar, Centre for Health Economics (CHE), University of York*
 - Seminar, IE University, Madrid*
 - Seminar, University of Lucerne*
 - Seminar, University of Lausanne*

- 2025
- Australian Gender Economics Workshop (AGEW), University of Wollongong
 - Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (ESPE), Naples
 - Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon), Nashville
 - Australasian Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics (AWEHE), Kuala Lumpur
 - International Health Economics Association (IHEA) Congress, Bali
 - Annual Australian Health Economics Doctoral (AHED) Workshop and Annual Australian Health Economics Society (AHES) Conference, Canberra
 - PhD Brown Bag, Department of Economics, University of Melbourne

- 2024
- AASLE 2024 Bangkok Conference
 - 5th Meeting of the Asian Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics, Guangzhou
 - CHE Internal Seminar, Centre for Health Economics, Monash University
 - PhD Brown Bag, Department of Economics, University of Melbourne
 - FBE GR Celebration Event Poster Competition, University of Melbourne

- 2023
- PhD Brown Bag, Department of Economics, University of Melbourne
 - Summer School in Applied Health Econometrics and Health Policy (AHEHP), University of Bergamo
 - Centro di ricerca sul Lavoro “Carlo Dell’Arling” (CRILDA) Seminar, Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore, Milan

- 2022
- 13th Annual Workshop of the University of Melbourne Health Economics Group
 - Workshop on the Economics of Health, Monash University

* Upcoming

Teaching

Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Melbourne

FACULTY TEACHING ASSISTANT

Introductory Microeconomics (ECON10004).

Melbourne, Australia

2022–current

Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Melbourne

FACULTY TEACHING ASSISTANT

Econometrics 2 (ECOM30002); Quantitative Methods 1 (ECON10005).

Melbourne, Australia

2022–2024

Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Melbourne

SUBSTITUTE LECTURER

Delivered one lecture for Econometrics 2 (ECOM30002).

Melbourne, Australia

2023

Indigenous Academic Enrichment Program, La Trobe University

FACULTY TEACHING ASSISTANT

Economic Issues and Public Policy (BBUS1IEI).

Melbourne, Australia

2023

Faculty of Business and Economics – Indigenous Tutorial Assistance Scheme, Murrup Barak, University of Melbourne

FACULTY TEACHING ASSISTANT

Applied Microeconomic Modelling (ECOM30003).

Melbourne, Australia

2022

Grants and Awards

- 2026 Jim Perkins PhD Travelling Scholarship
- 2025 University of Melbourne Faculty of Business and Economics Travel Grant
- 2024 University of Melbourne Faculty of Business and Economics Travel Grant
- 2024 University of Melbourne M.A. Bartlett Research Scholarship
- 2023 University of Melbourne Faculty Research Funds
- 2023 University of Melbourne Department Funds
- 2022 University of Melbourne Welcome Grant
- 2021 University of Melbourne Business and Economics Doctoral Program Scholarship
- 2014 Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore, Milan 100% Merit Scholarship

Professional Activities

- Referee for *Health Economics*, *Australian Economic Review*, and *Journal of Aging and Social Policy*.
- Discussant, 33rd European Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics (2026).
- Chair, PhD Session, 27th Labour Econometrics Workshop (2025).
- PhD Brown Bag coordinator, University of Melbourne (2023–2024).
- Research Assistant, Monash University (2023–2024).

References

- Kevin Staub (kevin.staub@unimelb.edu.au)
- Anthony Scott (anthony.scott@monash.edu)
- Susan J. Méndez (susan.mendez@unimelb.edu.au)
- Claudio Lucifora (claudio.lucifora@unicatt.it)